

Post-predicate bound oblique arguments across Kurdish

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Research questions and objectives

- Clitic oblique arguments across Kurdish, pre- or post predicate?
- Do they have different word order preferences than full oblique NPs?
- Are there differences in word order between clitic oblique arguments?
- Possible areal and contact-based explanations for the positioning of clitic arguments

1. Literature overview
2. Data and methodology

Challenges of analysis

word order preference: object-verb-oblique (OVX) or OXV?

Hierarchy of post-predicate bound oblique arguments

Oblique-verb order: X-V or V-X

3. Evidence from Aramaic of Sanandaj
4. Conclusions

1. Previous scholarship

Post-predicate oblique arguments across Kurdish (Haig 2014; to appear)

i) **Goals and directions of verbs of motions**

- 1) *Dihê* *ez* *çu-bû-m = e* *Duhok-ê*
Yesterday I go.pst-plprf-1sg = drct Duhok-f.obl
'I went to Duhok yesterday.'

ii) **GOAL with verbs of caused motion**

- 2) *Te* *nan* *kir = e* *di* *kîve* *da?*
2sg.obl bread do.pst = drct adp where adp
'Where did you put the bread?'

Post-predicate oblique arguments across Kurdish (Haig 2014; to appear)

iii) RECIPIENTS of *dan* ‘give’

- 3) *Te* *pare* *da-n = ev* *kê?*
 2sg.obl money give.pst-pl = drct who.obl
 ‘Who did you give the money to?’

iv) ADDRESSEES of ‘say’ *gotin*

- 4) *Min* *got = e* *Majid-î*
 1sg.obl say.pst = drct Majid = m.obl
 ‘I said to Majid’

Post-predicate oblique arguments across Kurdish (Haig 2014; to appear)

v) Final state complements of inchoative ‘become’ (*bûn*)

- 5) *Ez* *li* *2010ê* *bû-m = e* *mamosta*
 1sg in 2010.f.obl become.pst-1sg = drct teacher
 ‘In 2010 I became a teacher’ (e.g. I graduated, began working as a teacher)

vi) Light verb complements

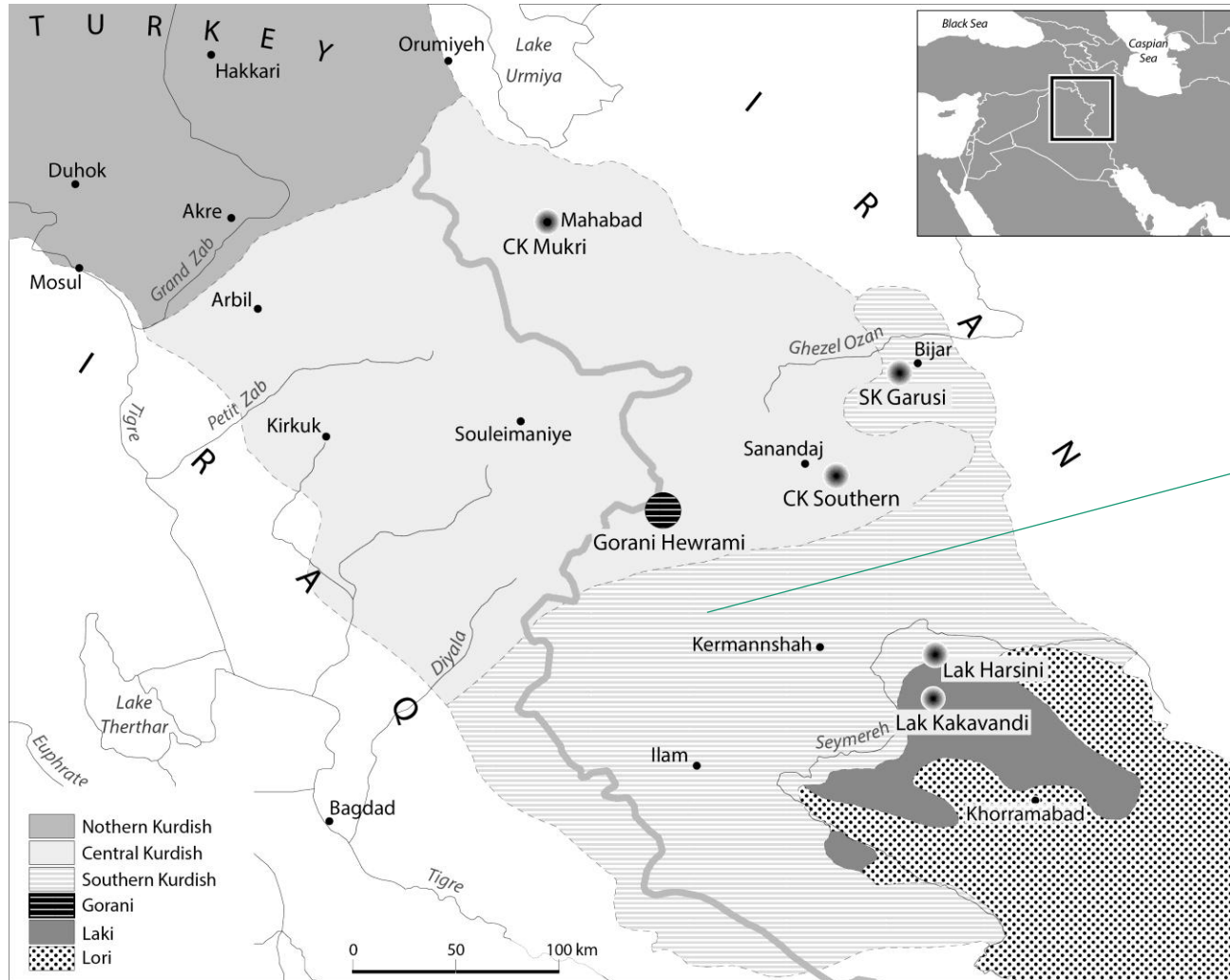
- 6) *Ez* *yê* *di-ke-m = e* *kenî*
 1sg ez.m ind-do.prs-1sg = drct laughing
 ‘I am laughing’

Post-predicate oblique arguments across Kurdish (Haig 2014; to appear)

“Within Kurdish, there is an areal fadeout, from the southeast (heaviest concentration of post-pred-args) fanning out northwards and westwards, with decreasing tolerance of post-predicate elements.”

Argument **types** in post-predicate position (provisional)

most likely post-predicate	goals of verbs of motion and caused motion recipient of <i>dan</i> final states of inchoatives (?) addressees of <i>gotin</i> other obliques, light verb complements
least likely post-predicate	(direct objects)



2. Data

- Mukri Central Kurdish: Öpengin (2016)
- Laki Harsini: Belelli (2016)
- Gorani Gawraju: Mahmoudveysi et al. (2012)
- Garusi Southern Kurdish: 3 folktales; 1 narration of 'pear story'; 40 minutes of conversation between two male speakers
- Southern Central Kurdish: 6 folktales; 1 life story
- Hawrami: 4 film retellings, 2 life stories
- Laki Kakewni: 10 film retellings

Corpus of bound (clitic) oblique arguments across under-investigated languages

- Mukri Central Kurdish: 117 clauses
- Laki Harsini: 79 clauses
- Gorani Gawraǰū: 97 clauses
- Garusi Southern Kurdish: 80 clauses
- Southern Central Kurdish: 100 clauses
- Hawrami: 70 clauses
- Laki Kakevandi: 121 clauses

CODE	CLAUSE	TRA	TENSE	transitivity	PERSON	PRP before	locality	PREPOSITION	ORDER
MQ.6	osâ swâr xâsê erâ=y bûre		PRS	TR	3SG	BEFORE	YES	erâ	OXV
MQ.28	we=t dey		PRS	TR	2SG	BEFORE	YES	we	
MQ.34	we=t dem		PRS	TR	2SG	BEFORE	YES	we	
MQ.39	mâyn qemenâz arây derârin le teöle		PRS	TR	3SG	BEFORE	YES	erâ	OXV
MQ.41	we=m büşe biro dir ûm		PRS	TR	1SG	BEFORE	YES	we	
MQ.42	we=m büşe bûse wisim		PRS	TR	1SG	BEFORE	YES	we	
MQ.46	zîn mîney min=iş bižene we=yâw swâ		PRS	TR	3SG	AFTER	YES	we	OVX
MQ.117	golân rêye den we=yâ diron		PRS	TR	3SG	AFTER	YES	we	
WC.7	şîr we=m be		PRS	TR	1SG	BEFORE	YES	we	OXV
WC.9	birû lây dare gelâ arâ=m biyâre		PRS	TR	1SG	BEFORE	YES	erâ	OXV
WC.9	tâ şîr we=t biyem		PRS	TR	2SG	BEFORE	YES	we	OXV
WC.10	gelâ we=m be		PRS	TR	1SG	BEFORE	YES	we	OXV
WC.12	birû le kênî âw erâ=m biyâre		PRS	TR	1SG	BEFORE	YES	erâ	OXV
WC.12	we=d bem		PRS	TR	2SG	BEFORE	YES	we	
WC.13	kênî âw we=m be		PRS	TR	1SG	BEFORE	YES	we	OXV
WC.15	âw we=d bem		PRS	TR	2SG	BEFORE	YES	we	OXV
WC.17	kewş erâ=mân biyârî		PRS	TR	1PL	BEFORE	YES	erâ	OXV
WC.19	mi eslen gîr le=m niye kewş bidîrnim		PRS	TR	1SG	BEFORE	YES	le	
WC.20	çwâr dâne xâ erâ=m biyârî		PRS	TR	1SG	BEFORE	YES	erâ	OXV
WC.22	mirêge îşê xâ we=m be		PRS	TR	1SG	BEFORE	YES	we	OXV
WC.23	yey miştê genim erâm biyârî		PRS	TR	1SG	BEFORE	YES	erâ	OXV
WC.24	xermân genim we=y dey		PRS	TR	3SG	BEFORE	YES	we	OXV
WC.27	mirwege xâ we=y dey		PRS	TR	3SG	BEFORE	YES	we	OXV

Challenges of analysis:

special syntax of prepositional object clitics

7) Hawrami

<i>zemâwin=iš</i>	<i>pey</i>	<i>gêro-n</i>
wedding=3SG	for	take.PRS-3PL

‘They throw a wedding party for her.’ (MK.21)

8) Laki Kakevandi

<i>golâwi = n-a</i>	<i>m-ey-a</i>	<i>bin</i>
pear = 3PL-IND	IND-give.PRS-DRC	to

‘He gives **them** pear(s).’

9) Mukri CK

<i>padšâ</i>	<i>meseleyek = î</i>	<i>lê</i>	<i>dâ-nâ-w-im</i>
king	problem = 3SG	at	PVB-put.PST-PTCP-1SG

‘The king has posed a problem for me (to solve).’ (Öpengin 2016: 203)

Solution:

Only cases where the clitic is locally realized on its prepositional head are analysed

Examples of clitic oblique arguments

Garusi SK

- 10) *[[yey mišt-ê genim]_{obj} [erâ = m]_{pp} [biyâr-î]_v]* **OXV**
 a punch-ez wheat **for = 1sg** subjv.bring.prs-2sg
 ‘That you bring me a punch of wheat.’ (WC. 23)

Laki Harsini

- 11) *ye lebās-e va ču ařā = m diris ka* **OXV**
 a cloth-ez from wood **for = 1sg** right make.imp.2sg
 ‘Make a wooden cloth for me.’ (Belelli 2016: 166)

Gorani Gawraju

- 12) *ūrdūy-ī ařā = š ma-kar-in* **OXV**
 camp-indf **for=3sg** ind-do.prs-3pl
 ‘They make a camp for him.’ (Mahmoudveysi et al 2012: 125)

Laki Harsini

- 13) *kamī gušt-i šotor beyna bin = im* OVX
abit meat-ez camel give.imp2sg to = 1sg
'Give me a little bit of Camel's meat.' (Belelli 2016: 206)

Gorani Gawraju

- 14) *-ī* *tāĵ-u* *taxtm-īč-a* *matim* **wan = it** **OVX**
 dem crown-and throne = add-dem1 ind.give.prs.1sg **to = 2sg**
 ‘I will also give this crown and my throne to you.’ (Mahmoudveysi et al 2012: 101)

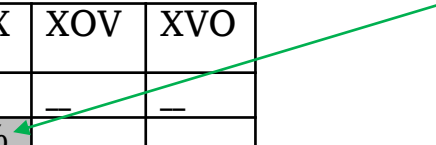
Southern CK

- 15) *asb = î* *henârd-ew* ***bo = y*** **OVX**
 horse = 3sg:a send.pst-ptc **for = 3sg**
 ‘He sent back the horse to him.’

Word order preferences of clitic oblique arguments

	OXV	OVX	XOV	XVO
Garusi SK	96%	4%	—	—
SCK	8%	92%	—	—
Gorani Gawraju	58%	42%	—	—
LakH	47%	38%	15%	—

past transitive constructions



While **OVX** can be considered the most unmarked word order for independent oblique arguments (Stilo 2018; Haig 2014; to appear), clitic oblique NPs frequently prefer OXV order across most Kurdish.

Word order difference among oblique arguments?

	test clause	BENEFICIARY		
		OVX	OXV	XOV
Garusi SK	10	0%	100%	0%
Gorani Gawraju	15	0%	100%	0%
Laki Harsini	22	0%	72%	28%

Word order difference among bound oblique arguments?

	test clause	RECIPIENT of 'give'		
		OVX	OXV	XOV
Garusi SK	12	0%	100%	0%
Gorani Gawraju	16	100%	0%	0%
Laki Harsini	14	100%	0%	0%

Hierarchy of post-verbal bound oblique arguments (preliminary)

Order of the verb (V) and oblique arguments (X): V-X or X-V

Order of *dan* ‘give’ and its recipient

Not applicable to Mukri

- 16) *nā = t-de-m-ē*
 neg = 2sg-give.prs-1sg-drc
 ‘I will not give (it) to you.’

Recipients of *dān* ‘give’; examples

17) Southern CK

nāyam *pê = t*
neg-give.prs-1sg to = 2sg
‘I won’t give (it) to you.’ (MN)

18) Hawrami Takht

mew *pana = šâ*
ind.give.prs.3sg to = 3pl
‘He gives (the pears) to them.’ (PS1. 29)

19) **Laki Harsini**
 ba-m-a *bin = it*
 sbjv-give.prs-1sg to = 2sg
 ‘That I give (it) to you.’ (Belelli 2016: 201)

20) **Garusi SK**
 wa = d *bam*
 to = 2sg sbjv.give.prs.1sg
 ‘That I give (it) to you.’ (WC. 12)

Recipients of *dān* ‘give’

	Mukri CK	SCK	Hawrami	Gorani Gawraju	LakH	LakK	Garusi SK
V-X	-	100%	100%	100%	100%	85%	0%
X-V	-	0%	0%	0%	0%	15%	100%

Rate of post-predicate recipients of ‘give’, 4 to 7 clauses for each location

- The CK of Baneh, spoken in the north of CK speech zone, pattern like Garusi SK in this regard.
- Except for the northern dialect of Garusi SK and CK of Bane, V-X is the norm across most Kurdish.

Order of the verb ‘say’ *gotin*, *witin* and the addressee

21) Mukri

pê = m *bile*

to = 1sg imp.tell.prs.2sg

‘Tell me.’ (Öpengin 2016: 197)

22) Garusi SK

sê *râ* *we = m* *wit-in*

three time to = 1sg say.pst-3pl

‘They told me three times’. (RRSh)

23) Hawrami

m-âç-o *pene = šâ*

ind.tell.prs-3sg to = 3pl

‘He tells them.’ (SM. 3)

Addressees of ‘say’ *gotin*, *witin*: examples

- 24) Laki Harsini
buš *aře*
imp.tell.2sg to.3sg
‘Tell him.’ (Belelli 2016: 144)
- 25) Southern CK
wit = î *pê = m*
tell.pst = 3sg to = 1sg
‘He told me.’ (LS. 10)
- 26) Laki Kakavandi
mûše *abin = ân*
ind.tell.prs.3sg to = 3pl
‘He tells them.’ (SMY. 15)

Adressees of ‘say’ *gotin*, *witin*

	Mukri CK	Garusi SK	SCK	Hawrmi	Gorani Gawraju	LakH	LakK
V-X	0%	0%	100%	80%	36%	40%	95%
X-V	100%	100%	0%	20%	64%	60%	5%

rate of post-predicate positioning of bound oblique arguments, 4 to 20 clauses for each location

- In the northern dialects, the order is strongly X-V
- In the contact area, V-X order is preferred.

3. Evidence from Aramaic of Sanandaj

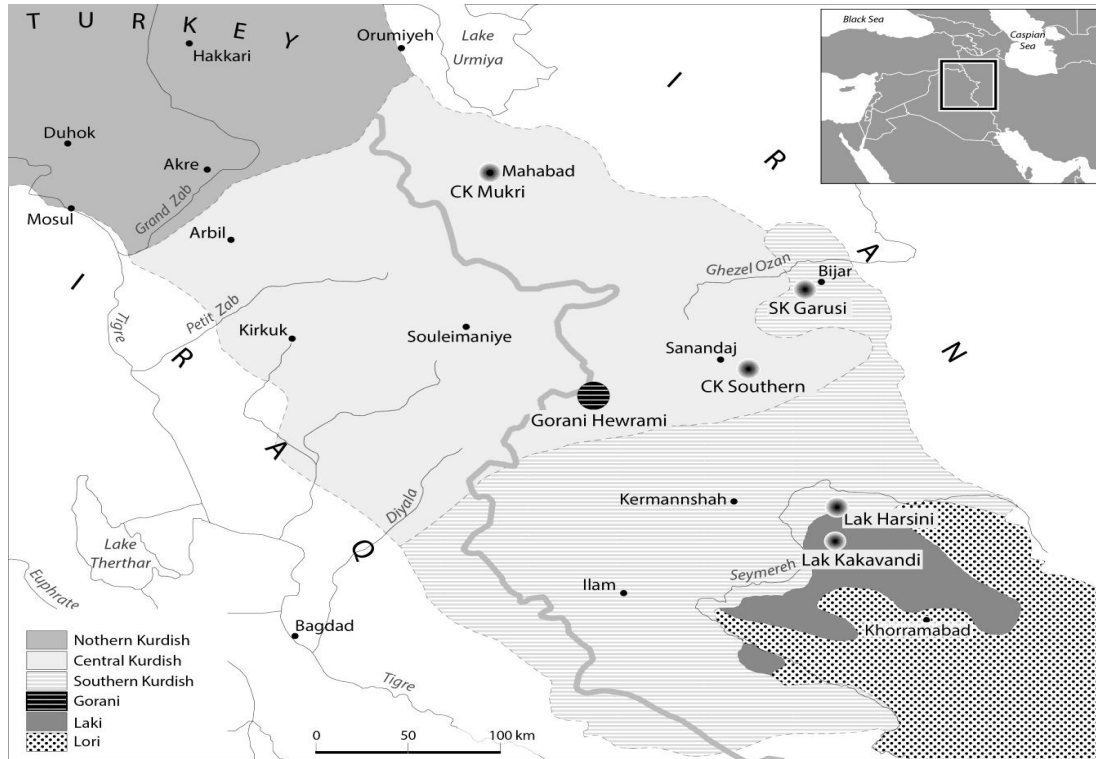
27) *hamránwa* ***baq(a)-ox^l***
say.pst.1sg to-2sg.m
'I would say to you.' (Khan 2009: 278)

28) *la* *kamratwa* ***baq(a)-ef***
neg say.pst.1sg to-3sg.m
'I would not say to him.' (Khan 2009: 399)

29) *kwi* ***baq(a)-ef***
give.prs.3pl to-3sg.m
'they will give to him.' (Khan 2009: 399)

20) *'o-lele* *xa-šām* *mfašál* *hiwlu* ***baqan-u^l***
that.night a-dinner copious give.pst.3pl to us
'That night they gave us a copious dinner.' (Khan 2009: 416)

4. Conclusions



- Probably a contact influence from non-Iranian languages, e.g. Neo-aramic once spoken in the region (Stilo 2018).
- an areal compromise?

Key points

- Clitic oblique arguments have different word order preferences than full oblique NPs: OXV VS. OVX
- A hierarchy of post-verbal clitic oblique arguments
- More northern dialects prefer pre-predicate positioning of clitic oblique arguments (perhaps having preserved the basic Iranian order?)
- Southern dialects prefer, at different rates, post-predicate positioning of clitic oblique arguments
- The different patterning of southern dialects might have resulted from the substratum effect of Aramaic dialects once spoken in the region.